

We are focused on both skill development and career-building programmes.”

—Naveen Kumar, Managing Director, Emtech Foundation

among them all,” informs Sreedharan.

“We can expect the decline of VHDL and the rise of the use of Verilog; more indigenous product design and product marketing by Indian companies for the Indian and overseas markets and more start-up activity in the product and software-as-a-service space and training industry will also evolve accordingly,” explains Khari.

“Companies are increasingly looking for professionals with hands-on experience in digital application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC) design, physical design, mixed-signal IC design, Verilog, VHDL or VHSIC, VLSI design, circuit design and simulations, microcontrollers, digital PCB design and routing,” says Kalra.

According to Parswanath, managing director, Eilabz, “ARM pre-processors and open source embedded software tools such as Linux, Android and AVX will be the sought after topics of training courses in the future.”

Partnering for success

While preparing growth strategies, both established and new training providers should remember partnership with the industry. Most of the successful market players maintain a multidimensional relationship with the industry. Utilisation of vendors as the customer of the finished products is a common practice.

Subbarangaiah says, “VEDA IIT consortium is an ideal example of the

partnership model. It consists of VLSI and embedded companies like AMD, Soctronics and Incube Solutions on the industry front, JNTU and AP State Council of Higher Education on the academic front and VEDA IIT on the institute front for conducting the PG degree programmes (MS in VLSI engineering) as per industry needs with active industry participation and also as per university norms and academic standards. This model is time-tested for more than a decade with 100 per cent recruitment history.”

“Our training programmes and activities are now collaborated with major companies in the field. We have had strategic tie-ups and partnerships with several leading players in the industry, such as Intel and Singapore-based Rhobhatah Robotic Solutions. We are also receiving enough support from leading microcontroller manufacturers like Microchip,” says Baker.

“We are the connecting partners of ARM. We also provide project training to final-year B.Tech, M.Tech, MCA and MSc students and continue R&D in power electronics and microcontroller-based embedded system design and development using ARM infrastructure,” informs Parswanath.

“University alliance programmes from companies like Cadence, Texas Instruments and Philips help in providing tools/training to institutions at subsidised rates and encourage the much required innovation and R&D in

Suggestions for betterment

1. Industry-academia partnership
2. Investment into R&D programmes
3. Initiatives to attract students/professionals from overseas
4. Closer collaboration with colleges
5. Better reach through virtual classrooms
6. Focus on embedded hardware
7. Focus on quality, meeting industry expectations and innovation
8. Building up domain knowledge
9. Knowledge management
10. Quick scale-up
11. Adopting effective methodology of training
12. Building brand recognition
13. Collaboration with the government and venture capital providers

this fast-emerging multi-disciplinary domain. More such programmes are yet to come,” says Raju.

Jukaku prefers to work with universities for revamping the curriculum, teacher training and certification programmes, allying with top-notch universities from India and abroad, and allying with top-notch hirers to provide targeted training.

Eureka, the innovation and technology incubation programme at Vector, is one such initiative in this direction. While the industry supports to incubate viable ideas from students and takes on board promising candidates for internships/R&D activities, the training institutes often try to make a profit out of this collaboration. For example, as the embedded products or electronic components are hardly available in the Indian market, these have started online trading of embedded products at affordable rates. In the process, they have business tie-ups with international companies.

Moving forward, all organisations across the segment should try for government-level partnership. “We have collaborated with the ministry of MSME, government of India, to avail all the facilities allotted for the SME segment,” says Kalra. ●

The author is a consultant—editorial, industry & academia interface at EFY

Engineering students are the most important for us followed by working professionals and corporate clients.”

—Col. N.C. Pande, Head, EFY TechCenter